

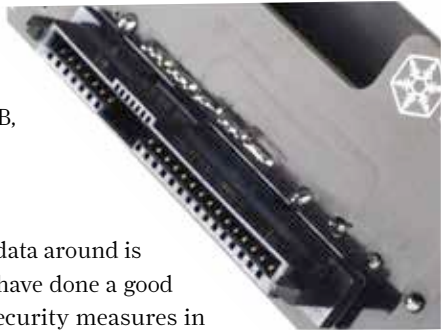
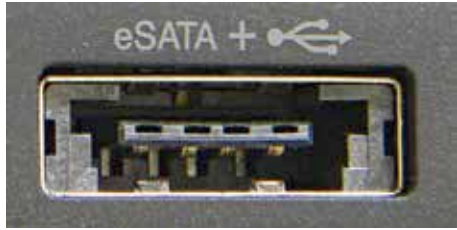
supplied is not enough to drive a hard disk so you still have to resort to an external source.

Hot Swap

Hot Swap is a feature of SATA architecture, so we

now have computer cabinets with one SATA + power port sticking out onto which we can directly place a hard drive without any sort of casing or intermediate interface. Since the power is sourced directly from the power supply unit you don't have to worry about external power in this case. Once inserted the drive will show up in your task bar under the "Safely Remove Hardware and Eject Media" icon. This allows for removing your hard disk completely from your computer and thus leaves it vulnerable to the elements. Also you need to be extra careful since there is no protective casing for your drive. If your computer cabinet does not have a hot swap bracket then investing in a hard drive dock could

prove to be prudent, these docks tend to have a host of connectivity options so you can hook it up using USB, FireWire or even Ethernet.



Security

A big concern while moving data around is security and manufacturers have done a good job at including biometric security measures in some of the devices that we can buy. However, you can encrypt your drives using easily available open source tools too. There is TrueCrypt which can be used to encrypt just a folder or the entire drive itself. Software encryption is comparatively easier to crack but depending upon the algorithm the time needed to crack an encryption can easily take more than a 100 years, so a hardware encryption is strong but the absence of it shouldn't be a major reason for you to not get a particular product.

What to buy

While getting a portable storage device keep the following points in mind.